GLOBAL STEWARDSHIP COUNCIL

FOUNDING CHARTER

2026 San José / Paris Framework

March 14, 2026

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This Charter belongs to no nation, no individual, and no political party.
It belongs to the Earth and to the generations who will inherit it.

PREAMBLE: FROM STATE SECURITY TO EARTH STEWARDSHIP

We, the founding Member States of the Global Stewardship Council, acknowledge that humanity stands at a civilisational crossroads — and that the architecture we inherit was not designed for this moment.

The 1945 United Nations Charter was built in the shadow of a particular war by a particular set of victors. It brought relative stability for eighty years. It also codified a world order in which five nations — those who had won — granted themselves permanent veto power over all collective action, and in which the peoples of Asia, Africa, the Middle East, and the Americas were largely excluded from the tables at which their futures were decided.

The consequences of that exclusion persist. The straight lines drawn across the Middle East by Britain and France at Sykes-Picot in 1916 without consulting those who lived there. The partition of Palestine in 1947 by a UN dominated by the same victors, without a plebiscite of the existing population. The partition of the Indian subcontinent in 1947 by a British lawyer in five weeks, drawing lines that displaced fifteen million people and created nuclear flashpoints that persist today. The overthrow of Iran's democratically elected government in 1953 to protect foreign oil concessions. **These were not aberrations of the 1945 system. They were its logical expression: sovereignty for the powerful; partition for the rest.**

We do not dissolve the United Nations. We propose to refresh it — for those nations willing to move forward — on a new foundation: **Earth Stewardship**. Under this principle, sovereignty is not an absolute privilege. It is a fiduciary duty. Nations hold their territory, their resources, their linguistic heritage, and their data infrastructure in trust — for their own people, for all living beings, **and for the generations who will inherit whatever world we leave them**.

The expiry of the New START Treaty on February 5, 2026 — leaving the world without legally binding nuclear limits for the first time in half a century — and the integration of unregulated artificial intelligence into military targeting systems — has made the inadequacy of the 1945 architecture an existential matter, not merely an institutional one. When algorithms select targets and great powers veto accountability, the 1945 system does not merely fail. It accelerates harm.

The Core Shift

From 'the right to dominate' to 'the duty to protect.'

From 'might makes right' to 'stewardship makes right.'

From winner-determined maps to people-determined sovereignty.

From algorithms without accountability to humans who bear legal responsibility for every lethal decision.

We acknowledge that no charter is perfect, and that this one will require revision as the world changes. Amendment procedures are included precisely because we do not presume to have all the answers — only the courage to begin.

PART I: THE STRUCTURAL SHIFT — OLD UN vs. GLOBAL STEWARDSHIP COUNCIL

Feature	Old UN (1945 Charter)	GSC (2026 San José / Paris Charter)
Power Logic	Veto power for the 'Big 5' — might makes right	Weighted Stewardship Majority — contribution makes right. No single nation can block collective action.
Voting Threshold	P5 veto blocks any resolution	Ordinary: 60% weighted majority. Constitutional: 75%. Emergency: 2/3.
Primary Duty	Territorial integrity and state security	Earth Stewardship and the rights of present and future generations
Governance Base	New York — subject to host-nation political pressure	San José, Costa Rica — constitutionally demilitarized, neutral, biodiverse
Dispute Resolution	Lengthy legal battles; resolutions frequently vetoed	Graduated response: mediation → arbitration → economic measures → collective action
Who Has a Voice	Nation-states only	Nations + Indigenous Elders Council + Future Generations Ombudsperson
Nuclear Accountability	Nuclear-armed states can veto any resolution on their arsenals	Nuclear threats trigger automatic Coercion Penalty; voting weight reduced until verified withdrawal
Funding Model	Voluntary dues — frequently unpaid or withheld as leverage	Sovereign Data Royalty, Stewardship Credits, voluntary defence conversion — self-funding
AI Governance	No binding framework	Human-in-the-Loop requirement with defined review standard; violations trigger Coercion Penalty
Amendment	Requires P5 agreement — practically frozen	75% weighted majority + ratification by 2/3 of member states; core principles unamendable
Withdrawal	Permitted without consequence	Permitted with 24-month notice; financial obligations survive withdrawal
Entry Into Force	Operative on ratification by original P5	Operative when signed by minimum 5 Tier 1 Founding Stewards (see Article IX)

ARTICLE I: PURPOSES AND PRINCIPLES

Section 1 — The Principle of Earth Trusteeship

The primary purpose of the Council is the preservation and restoration of the Earth System. Sovereignty is no longer an absolute privilege but a fiduciary duty. Each Member State acknowledges that it holds its territory, natural resources, linguistic heritage, and data infrastructure in trust for the benefit of all living beings and future generations.

This principle is grounded in the **Earth Trusteeship Initiative** and the legal work of the Hague Institute for Global Justice on shifting international law from 'ownership' to 'guardianship.' It draws equally from the Indigenous principle that humans are stewards, not owners, of the land — a principle present across cultures from the Haudenosaunee Seventh Generation teaching to the concept of Vasudhaiva Kutumbakam ('the world is one family').

- Earth Trusteeship Initiative — foundational legal framework
- Hague Institute for Global Justice — sovereignty as guardianship

Section 2 — Abolition of Hegemonic Hierarchy and Voting Thresholds

The Council operates on the principle of Sovereign Equality through Stewardship. The Veto Power of the previous era is hereby abolished. No single nation, regardless of military or economic size, shall have the power to obstruct the collective will of the Council.

VOTING THRESHOLDS — All Council decisions require the following weighted majority of Weighted Stewardship Index scores:

Decision Type	Required Majority	Examples
Ordinary Resolution	60% of weighted votes	Annual budget, programme approvals, membership applications
Emergency Resolution	2/3 of weighted votes + quorum of 50% of members	Nuclear threat response, AI targeting violation, Planetary Boundary emergency
Constitutional Amendment	75% of weighted votes + ratification by 2/3 of member states within 18 months	Changes to Charter Articles; new permanent institutions
Core Principle Protection	Unamendable — no threshold suffices	Abolition of veto; Human-in-the-Loop standard; Seventh Generation Audit requirement; nuclear emergency response
Quorum	50% of member states by count AND 60% by weighted vote	Without quorum, no binding resolutions may be passed

This abolition does not remove large nations from the table. It removes their ability to hold the table hostage. **Every nation retains a vote; no nation retains a veto.**

Section 3 — The Mandate of Intergenerational Equity (The Seventh Generation Audit)

All decisions of the Council — military, economic, industrial, or technological — must be eligible for a Seventh Generation Audit before implementation. The Audit asks:

> **The Audit Question**
>
> If this action is taken today, will the people living 140 years from now — seven generations hence — have a liveable, biodiverse, and politically just world to inhabit?
>
> **The burden of proof lies with the proposing party to demonstrate safety**, not with the opposing party to demonstrate harm.

AUDIT IMPLEMENTATION PROCEDURE:

1. The Future Generations Ombudsperson (Article V) may flag any proposed Council action for a Seventh Generation Audit within 14 days of formal notice of that action.
2. Upon flagging, a panel of three independent assessors is convened: one nominated by the Ombudsperson, one by the proposing party, and one by the Indigenous Elders Council.
3. The panel has 90 days to produce a written assessment against five criteria: (a) biosphere viability, (b) climate trajectory, (c) nuclear and weapons risk, (d) political and civic freedom, and (e) intergenerational equity of resource distribution.
4. The panel's finding is advisory but must be publicly published and formally addressed by the Council before any vote on the flagged action.
5. If the panel finds irreversible harm to any of the five criteria, implementation is suspended until a 75% weighted majority votes to override — and that vote must include a formal statement of justification entered permanently into the Council record.
6. Appeals may be submitted by any member state to the Dispute Resolution Chamber within 30 days of a panel finding.

- Maastricht Principles on Future Generations (OHCHR)

Section 4 — Nuclear Accountability

The following acts automatically trigger the Coercion Penalty:

- Issuing an explicit or implicit nuclear threat (defined as: any statement by a head of state, defence minister, or military commander that could reasonably be interpreted as threatening nuclear use, regardless of whether the word 'nuclear' is used)
- Conducting a nuclear weapons test
- Deploying nuclear weapons in a manner inconsistent with the NPT, or to a non-nuclear-weapons state without Council authorisation
- Refusing IAEA inspection of a facility under Additional Protocol obligations

Upon triggering, the Coercion Penalty reduces that state's Weighted Stewardship Index score by 40–80% (calibrated to severity) until all three conditions are met: the threat is formally withdrawn; an independent verification mission confirms de-escalation; and the state re-engages with binding nuclear limits.

Nuclear use — even 'limited' or 'tactical' — constitutes automatic grounds for an emergency Council session within 72 hours and activates the full Graduated Response Protocol (Article V §4).

- ICAN — Campaign to Abolish Nuclear Weapons (Nobel Peace Prize)
- Arms Control Association — New START Expiry and consequences
- Bulletin of the Atomic Scientists — Doomsday Clock

Section 5 — AI Governance and the Human-in-the-Loop Standard

No Member State may deploy or authorise the deployment of artificial intelligence in any system that recommends, selects, or executes lethal force without meeting the following Human-in-the-Loop Standard:

Requirement	Standard
Qualified human reviewer	A commissioned military officer of rank O-4 (Major/Lieutenant-Commander) or above, trained in international humanitarian law (IHL) and **specifically certified in AI-assisted targeting review**
Minimum review time	No less than 60 seconds of active deliberation per individual targeting decision. Speed of operations may not be used as justification for bypassing this standard.
Documentation	Each targeting decision must be logged with: reviewer ID, timestamp, AI recommendation, human decision, and written justification where the human decision diverges from the AI recommendation
Meaningful refusal	The reviewing commander must have the practical ability — technical access and clear legal authority — to refuse, modify, or delay any targeting decision at any point
System certification	All AI targeting systems must be certified by an independent technical body approved by the Council before deployment; certification lapses after 24 months and requires renewal

This is not a technology ban. It is an accountability standard. AI may assist commanders; it may not replace them. Any AI system that removes the practical capacity for human refusal from a targeting chain — including through interface design, speed requirements, or command structure — is in breach of this Charter regardless of formal compliance with any other provision.

Violations trigger the Coercion Penalty and may be referred to the International Criminal Court under the Principle of Command Responsibility (Rome Statute Article 28).

- Rome Statute — Command Responsibility (Article 28)
- REAIM Call to Action — 60+ nations on responsible AI in military
- UN General Assembly Resolution 78/265 — first global AI governance resolution
- UN GA Resolution 79/239 — AI in the military domain (2025)

Section 6 — The Prohibition on Coercive Economic Acts

Economic relations between Member States must be governed by mutual benefit, not coercive leverage. The following acts, when applied by one Member State against another without Council authorisation, trigger the Coercion Penalty:

- Imposition of tariffs exceeding WTO-bound rates when used as leverage for political compliance rather than as a legitimate trade remedy
- Economic blockades against civilian populations
- Extraterritorial sanctions applied against third-party states or companies for trading with a Council member under Council-endorsed frameworks
- Transnational repression of diaspora communities — including surveillance, intimidation, or coercion of nationals living in other Member States
- Use of debt instruments to extract political compliance from smaller economies

The Coercion Penalty for economic acts is calibrated at 10–30% of voting weight reduction, proportional to the economic harm caused and the degree of political coercion demonstrated. It is automatically reversed upon cessation of the coercive act and payment of assessed compensation to affected parties.

- WTO Dispute Settlement Understanding
- EU Anti-Coercion Instrument — model for collective response

ARTICLE II: MEMBERSHIP — FOUNDING STEWARDS AND PATHWAY TO ACCESSION

The GSC is not a closed club. It is an open invitation. Any nation willing to accept the fiduciary duties of Earth Stewardship, submit to the Weighted Stewardship Index, and participate in the Seventh Generation Audit mechanism may apply for membership. Membership is tiered to reflect the organic development of the Council.

Tier 1: Founding Stewards — Core Architecture Committee

These nations will draft the Charter and design the Weighted Stewardship Index. They commit to the full framework from Day One.

Nation	Why Essential	Strategic Role	Coalition Breadth
India	World's largest democracy; 1.4 billion people; linguistic sovereignty model; natural bridge between Global South and G7; unmatched moral authority on AI data rights	Co-architect alongside anchor Western state; provides Global South legitimacy that Western nations alone cannot	Bridges non-Western and democratic perspectives; counterweight to both major power blocs
Anchor G7 Western State	G7 member; EU digital alliance; neutral convener; rich natural assets; convening power with both South Asian and Pacific partners	Lead convener and charter drafter; provides 'responsible Western state' credibility	Anchor of Western democratic values; signals GSC is not anti-Western
EU / Major European State	World's most advanced AI governance framework; Anti-Coercion Instrument; 27 member states; largest trading bloc	Legal and institutional architecture; ensures transatlantic continuity	Core EU partner; institutionalises rules-based order with full European weight
Major Francophone Security Council State	UN Security Council permanent member and active reform advocate; nuclear deterrent willing to submit to GSC oversight	Security Council insider credibility; bridges Old UN and New GSC architectures	Maintains Western security credibility while supporting veto abolition — uniquely persuasive
Pacific G7 State (nuclear attack survivor)	G7 member; technology leader; only nation to have suffered nuclear attack in war — gives nuclear accountability provisions unimpeachable moral authority	Pacific anchor; moral authority on nuclear trauma; AI governance partner	Essential Asia-Pacific democratic anchor; deeply trusted by regional and Western allies alike

Tier 2: Stewardship Council Members — Initial Signatories

Profile	Strategic Value	Coalition Breadth
Pacific democratic security partner	Five Eyes-equivalent credibility; Pacific environmental steward; ethical AI framework complement to existing security alliances	High — independent streak on climate and digital sovereignty
Advanced AI economy under nuclear threat	Advanced AI and technology sector; direct nuclear threat exposure gives unique standing on nuclear accountability provisions	High — seeks multilateral reassurance beyond bilateral frameworks
Nordic democratic science bloc	Planetary Boundary science leadership (Stockholm Resilience Centre); sovereign cloud infrastructure; democratic governance models respected globally	Very High — strong environmental records; universally palatable
International court host state	Host of the International Court of Justice and Permanent Court of Arbitration — natural institutional anchor for GSC dispute resolution	Very High — respected legal institution host
Proposed GSC host — constitutionally demilitarized state	Constitutionally abolished military since 1948; 98%+ renewable electricity; ~30% territory protected; generates international trust through neutrality	High — neutral, environmentally exemplary, no military threat to anyone

Tier 3: Observer Status and Pathway to Full Membership

Profile	Rationale for Inclusion	Pathway Timeline
Major Commonwealth partner	Deep historical role in UN architecture; may deepen multilateral engagement as bilateral security alignments evolve	Post-founding, 2026–2027
Amazon steward — major Global South economy	World's largest tropical rainforest; essential Global South voice; would receive highest possible Biodiversity Index scores	Post-Rio Earth Summit (late 2026)
African Union (rotating chair)	Represents 55 nations; Congo Basin — world's second-largest tropical forest; critical for biodiversity and freshwater	Post-2027; AU engagement begins at founding ceremony
Indo-Pacific archipelago mega-state	World's largest archipelago; extraordinary marine and terrestrial biodiversity; ASEAN leadership	2027; through regional partners
Major nuclear power — largest economy not yet member	Cannot be excluded from any framework claiming global legitimacy on nuclear risk or climate; observer status keeps dialogue open	Pathway opens 2027–2028; Coercion Penalty designed to reduce, not eliminate, influence

ARTICLE III: THE WEIGHTED STEWARDSHIP INDEX — HOW VOTING POWER IS CALCULATED

WEIGHTED STEWARDSHIP INDEX — HOW VOTES ARE CALCULATED

Vote Weight (V) =
(Population + Biodiversity + Sustainability + Democracy) ÷ (4 × (1 + Coercion Penalty)

Nations gain influence by having large populations, protecting ecosystems, meeting climate targets, and upholding democratic rights.

They lose influence through nuclear threats, economic coercion, or AI targeting without human oversight. No nation retains a veto. Every nation retains a voice.

In the current United Nations, power comes from military strength and historical accident. **In the Global Stewardship Council, power comes from what you contribute to the planet and to justice — and is reduced by what you take away.**

The Formula

Vote Weight (V) = (P + B + S + D) ÷ (4 × (1 + C))

P = Population Factor | B = Biodiversity Index | S = Sustainability Score
D = Democracy & Human Rights Index | C = Coercion Penalty

Each factor P, B, S, D is a normalised score between 0.0 and 1.0, giving a maximum raw sum of 4.0.

Dividing by 4 normalises V to a scale of 0.0–1.0 for clean comparison across members.

P is additionally capped so that no nation's population factor may exceed 3× the median member score.

C is added to 1 in the denominator, not multiplied — so even the highest penalty reduces, never eliminates, influence.

Factor Definitions and Anti-Gaming Rules

Code	Factor	What It Measures	Data Source & Anti-Gaming Rule
P	Population Factor	Population as a proportion of the median member state, capped at 3× median. Ensures large democracies have voice proportional to their peoples without demographic domination.	UN Population Division (annual). Anti-gaming: five-year rolling averages used — temporary census adjustments cannot inflate scores.
B	Biodiversity / Ecological Health Index	Health and extent of protected ecosystems: forests, oceans, wetlands, grasslands, and species diversity. Nations that deforest see their score fall in real time.	IPBES Global Biodiversity Assessment + IUCN Red List. Anti-gaming: satellite verification required; self-reported figures not accepted without independent corroboration.
S	Sustainability Score	Adherence to the Nine Planetary Boundaries (carbon emissions, freshwater use, nitrogen cycles, ocean acidification, etc.) as defined by the Stockholm Resilience Centre.	Stockholm Resilience Centre + IPCC data. Anti-gaming: historical emissions included, not just current trajectory, preventing 'dirty start, clean pivot' strategies.
D	Democracy & Human Rights Index	Independent judiciaries, press freedom, minority protections, absence of systemic repression. Autocracies score lower but are not excluded.	Freedom House + V-Dem Institute + UN Human Rights Council — three independent sources triangulated; no single source can be gamed.
C	Coercion Penalty	Applied for: nuclear threats; military aggression without Council authorisation; illegal economic coercion; transnational repression; AI targeting without human review. Calibrated 0.0–1.5.	Determined by the three-member Coercion Assessment Panel (one elected by General Assembly, one by a regional bloc, one independent jurist). Decisions appealable within 30 days.

Independent Scoring Body — The SDVO

Annual scores for all factors are calculated by the GSC Statistical and Data Verification Office (SDVO), operating under the following independence guarantees:

- Staff drawn from secondments from IPBES, the Stockholm Resilience Centre, Freedom House, V-Dem, and the UN Statistics Division
- No SDVO staff member may be a national of any state whose score is under active Coercion Penalty review
- All underlying data, methodologies, and calculations published on the GSC open-data portal and subject to independent academic audit
- Any member state may challenge its own score within 60 days of publication; challenges adjudicated by the Dispute Resolution Chamber

Worked Examples — Illustrative Only, Based on 2026 Estimates

These examples are provided for transparency and calibration only. They are not binding determinations. Actual scores are calculated annually by the SDVO using the methodology above.

Nation (illustrative)	P	B	S	D	C	V = (P+B+S+D) ÷ 4(1+C)	Net effect vs. Old UN
High-performing G7 Arctic state	0.35	0.82	0.74	0.91	0.00	0.71	↑ ~2.5× its GDP-weighted share; rewarded for environmental stewardship and human rights
World's largest democracy	1.00	0.71	0.58	0.68	0.00	0.74	↑ Massive increase; population + biodiversity combination finally matched by commensurate influence
Major EU economy	0.42	0.61	0.79	0.93	0.00	0.69	↑ Increase; rewarded for AI governance leadership and democratic institutions
Amazon steward	0.55	0.95	0.52	0.71	0.00	0.68	↑ Major increase; Amazon biodiversity creates powerful incentive to protect, not sell
Major economic power — high coercion	0.65	0.58	0.43	0.72	0.19	0.50	↓ Reduced from current Security Council dominance; retains strong voice; penalty reverses when coercive acts cease
Military aggressor — nuclear threats	0.25	0.74	0.41	0.22	0.45	0.28	↓ Substantially reduced; retains seat and voice; full recovery possible if behaviour changes

- Stockholm Resilience Centre — Planetary Boundaries
- IPBES Global Biodiversity Assessment
- Freedom House — Freedom in the World
- V-Dem Institute — Democracy Report

ARTICLE IV: FUNDING — SOLVING THE UN FINANCIAL CRISIS

The United Nations is financially paralysed because its funding model relies on voluntary contributions from the very nations it is designed to hold accountable. **The GSC is designed to be self-funding through mechanisms that align financial incentives with the behaviours the Council seeks to encourage.**

Funding Stream	Mechanism	Scale Estimate	Legal Precedent
Sovereign Data Royalty	A 0.5% gross revenue royalty paid by any AI company with market capitalisation exceeding $1 trillion USD that uses sovereign linguistic or cultural data for LLM training, collected through the Linguistic Data License Agreement (LDLA).	Potentially several billion USD annually	Multiple national online news and AI transparency acts; EU AI Act Art. 53
Stewardship Credits	Nations earn annually tradeable credits (Stewardship Units / SUs) for carbon sequestration, biodiversity protection, freshwater conservation, and ocean health. Credits may be traded or used to offset GSC contribution assessments. Anti-manipulation: a dedicated SU Integrity Board audits all claims with satellite verification.	$50–100B annually by 2030	Kunming-Montreal Biodiversity Framework; Paris Agreement Article 6
Voluntary Defence Conversion	Member States may redirect up to 1% of annual military budget to the Planetary Boundary Restoration Fund, receiving voting credits that partially offset Coercion Penalty calculations or increase their Sustainability Score.	1% of $2.4 trillion global military spending = $24B if fully subscribed	Constitutional demilitarisation precedents in several member states
Alternative Security Arrangement Conversion	Nations that would otherwise pay fees to parallel private security arrangements redirect that capital to the GSC's environmental monitoring grid, receiving equivalent collective stewardship guarantees under the Council's collective defence provisions.	$500M–$1B per nation redirected	EU Anti-Coercion Instrument (ACI)

Anti-Corruption and Integrity Safeguards

- All GSC accounts audited annually by an external auditor appointed by the Assembly with no financial relationship to any member state
- The Stewardship Credits market regulated by the SU Integrity Board, with authority to suspend trading, order restitution, and recommend Coercion Penalties for systematic fraud
- All Sovereign Data Royalty collections and disbursements published on the open-data portal within 90 days of each financial year
- No LDLA royalty may be diverted for military purposes; all proceeds ring-fenced to the Planetary Boundary Restoration Fund and Council operating budget
- Kunming-Montreal Global Biodiversity Framework
- EU Anti-Coercion Instrument

ARTICLE V: INSTITUTIONS, ARCHITECTURE, AND GRADUATED RESPONSE

The Council Assembly

All Member States participate in the Council Assembly on the basis of their Weighted Stewardship Index score. The Assembly meets in regular session twice annually and in emergency session within 72 hours of any nuclear threat, AI-assisted strike without human-in-the-loop compliance, or Planetary Boundary emergency. Emergency sessions may be convened by the Stewardship Commission, the Future Generations Ombudsperson, or a petition of 30% of member states by count.

The Stewardship Commission

A standing executive body of 15 members elected by the Assembly for three-year terms, weighted by Stewardship Index scores but with guaranteed seats for each tier of membership. The Commission manages the Planetary Boundary Restoration Fund, coordinates emergency response, and oversees the SDVO's independence. No member of the Commission may hold executive office in a member state government simultaneously.

The Secretary-General

The Assembly elects a Secretary-General by 60% weighted majority for a single five-year term. The Secretary-General is the chief administrative officer of the Council, serves as depositary of this Charter and all instruments of accession, certifies the text of any amendment entering into force, and convenes emergency sessions of the Assembly upon the triggers specified in Article V. The Secretary-General may not be a national of any state currently subject to a Coercion Penalty.

The Future Generations Ombudsperson

An independent officer appointed by the Assembly for a single five-year term, renewable once. Has the right to flag any proposed action for Seventh Generation Audit, address the Assembly on any matter, and commission independent expert reports. The Ombudsperson may not be removed except by a 75% weighted vote of the Assembly.

The Indigenous Elders Council

A consultative body of Indigenous knowledge-holders from all bioregions, with the right to address the Assembly and the Stewardship Commission on any matter relating to land stewardship, water rights, biodiversity, and intergenerational obligations. The Elders Council has formal standing in all Seventh Generation Audits; its consensus finding carries a 10% additional weighting in the panel's assessment.

The Elders Council is not subordinate to any member state government. **Its members are nominated by their own communities, not appointed by governments.**

The Statistical and Data Verification Office (SDVO)

A permanent technical body responsible for the annual calculation of all Weighted Stewardship Index scores. The SDVO operates under the independence standards specified in Article III and reports to the Council Assembly, not to the Stewardship Commission, ensuring separation of technical assessment from executive action.

The Dispute Resolution Chamber

A standing judicial body of seven jurists, nominated by the Assembly and confirmed by 60% weighted vote, serving staggered six-year terms. The Chamber follows the Graduated Response Protocol:

Stage	Trigger	Mechanism	Timeline
1 — Diplomatic	Any alleged violation of the Charter	Formal notification + 30-day response window + mediated dialogue	0–60 days
2 — Arbitration	No resolution at Stage 1	Binding arbitration by a three-member panel; findings publicly published	60–180 days
3 — Economic Measures	Failure to comply with arbitration finding	Targeted Stewardship Credit suspension; access restrictions to Council programmes	180 days +
4 — Collective Response	Continued non-compliance or acute emergency (nuclear use, mass atrocity)	Council Assembly votes on: asset freezes, trade embargoes, referral to ICC, and — as last resort, by 2/3 emergency majority only — authorisation of collective defence	Emergency: 72 hours

Honest Enforcement Doctrine — What the GSC Can and Cannot Do

The GSC does not maintain a standing military force. It cannot physically prevent a military action in real time. This is an honest limitation that this Charter acknowledges, rather than papers over.

What the GSC can do: impose graduated economic and diplomatic costs that make aggression progressively more expensive; reduce the aggressor's international legitimacy and voting weight; refer individuals to the International Criminal Court; and, as a last resort with a 2/3 emergency majority, authorise collective defence measures.

The goal is not instant enforcement but persistent consequence — making sustained aggression so diplomatically and economically costly that it becomes irrational.

Headquarters: San José, Costa Rica

- The world's only independent nation that has constitutionally abolished its military (1948 Constitution, Article 12) — neutrality acceptable to all blocs
- Over 98% of electricity from renewable sources; ~30% of territory protected as national parks — exemplary environmental stewardship
- Hosts the Inter-American Court of Human Rights — deep institutional culture of international legal engagement
- Western Hemisphere location provides time-zone accessibility for North American, European, and initial Indo-Pacific members
- Costa Rica Ministry of Foreign Affairs — proposed GSC host nation

ARTICLE VI: DOMESTIC IMPLEMENTATION — SUBNATIONAL GOVERNMENTS, INDIVIDUALS, AND COMMUNITIES

The Global Stewardship Council is not only an international institution. **It is a framework that must be lived at the community level to have meaning**. Each Member State is responsible for adapting the following implementation framework to its own constitutional structure, **recognising that in many nations education, land stewardship, and data governance are administered at the sub-national rather than national level.**

Sector	Responsibility	Specific Action
Subnational Governments (states, provinces, regions, prefectures — wherever education authority resides under a Member State's constitution)	Pivot from passive civics education to active Earth Citizenship at the secondary level	Update curricula to include Global Stewardship Studies: the Seventh Generation Audit, Planetary Boundaries science, AI literacy, and digital sovereignty. Students participate in mock GSC Assembly debates arguing from the perspective of future generations, not current national borders. A Belief Autopsy exercise — helping students identify whether their views are genuinely their own or algorithmically shaped — is included in the media literacy strand.
Municipalities and Local Governments	Local environmental monitoring and data contribution	Form Bio-Regional Councils that monitor local water quality, soil health, air quality, and biodiversity. This data feeds directly into the GSC's global environmental monitoring grid — transforming local stewardship action into measurable voting currency for the Member State under the Weighted Stewardship Index.
Individuals	Data sovereignty and responsible digital citizenship	Move personal digital data to Sovereign Cloud cooperatives located in jurisdictions with strong data protection laws and GSC membership. Use available technical tools to prevent unauthorised AI scraping of personal creative and cultural content. Exercise rights under applicable national and regional data protection law to request deletion of personal data held by large AI platforms.
Civil Society and Academia	Independent monitoring and accountability	Document and report AI-led surveillance, biodiversity loss, and coercive acts to the Future Generations Ombudsperson. Publish independent findings in the GSC's open data portal, accessible to all Assembly members. Provide expert input into Seventh Generation Audit panels when called upon.

Sector	Responsibility	Specific Action
Indigenous Communities	Custodianship of traditional ecological knowledge	Traditional ecological knowledge is held under LDLA guardianship principles. It is recognised as sovereign data — it cannot be extracted, trained upon by AI systems, or commodified without the free, prior, and informed consent of the community, and without fair and ongoing compensation agreed by that community on its own terms.
Private Sector and Technology Companies	Responsible innovation within Member State jurisdictions	Comply with the Sovereign Data Royalty (Article IV) where applicable. Adopt the Human-in-the-Loop standard (Article I §5) as a condition of operating in GSC member markets. Participate in Stewardship Credits markets transparently and subject to SU Integrity Board oversight.

ARTICLE VII: SIGNING TIMELINE AND MILESTONES

Date	Event	Forum	Milestone
March–April 2026	Confidential diplomatic outreach to prospective Tier 1 Founding Stewards and multilateral partners	Bilateral diplomatic channels	Charter shared with prospective Founding Stewards; feedback incorporated into final text; verbal commitments sought
April–May 2026	NPT Review Conference Engagement	UN, New York	Founding Stewards table GSC nuclear accountability provisions; nuclear clause given multilateral legal grounding; asymmetries in current NPT regime formally named
May 2026	Technology and AI Governance Ministerial	G7 Presidency forum	Table AI Human-in-the-Loop standard as a multilateral consensus item; align with 'human-centered AI' governance priorities
June 5, 2026	FOUNDING CHARTER SIGNING — World Environment Day	San José, Costa Rica	Full Charter signed by Tier 1 Founding Stewards and confirmed Tier 2 members. GSC formally operational. Open invitation extended to all UN member states.
July–August 2026	Bilateral trade review integration	Founding Steward capitals	Founding Stewards present GSC standards as technical safety standards in ongoing bilateral and multilateral trade reviews — framing stewardship as shared economic security infrastructure, not trade barrier
September 2026	First Council Assembly	San José, Costa Rica	Inaugural session; election of Stewardship Commission and Secretary-General; appointment of Future Generations Ombudsperson; first Planetary Boundary Report published

ARTICLE VIII: AMENDMENT, WITHDRAWAL, AND SUSPENSION

Section 1 — Amendment Procedure

7. Any Member State may propose an amendment by submitting the proposed text to the Stewardship Commission with a written rationale.
8. The Commission circulates the proposal to all member states. A period of six months for public consultation and member state deliberation follows.
9. The proposal is put to a vote of the Council Assembly. Passage requires a 75% weighted majority.
10. Following passage, the amendment requires ratification by 2/3 of member states (by count) within 18 months to enter into force.
11. Certain core principles are UNAMENDABLE under any threshold: (a) the abolition of the veto; (b) the Human-in-the-Loop standard for AI in targeting; (c) the Seventh Generation Audit requirement; (d) the prohibition on nuclear use as grounds for emergency response; (e) the consultative standing of the Indigenous Elders Council.

Section 2 — Withdrawal

12. Any Member State may withdraw from the GSC by submitting written notification to the Secretary-General.
13. Withdrawal takes effect 24 months after notification is received, during which the withdrawing state retains all rights and obligations of membership.
14. Financial obligations — including outstanding Stewardship Credit assessments and Sovereign Data Royalty contributions — survive withdrawal and remain legally enforceable.
1. A withdrawing state may reapply for membership at any time after withdrawal takes effect. Re-accession requires 60% weighted majority approval.

Section 3 — Suspension

2. A Member State may be suspended from Council Assembly voting — but not expelled — by a 2/3 emergency weighted majority if it: commits military aggression against a Member State without Council authorisation; refuses to comply with two consecutive binding Dispute Resolution Chamber findings; or engages in systematic genocide, mass atrocity, or crimes against humanity.
3. Suspension is reviewed every 12 months. It is lifted automatically when the triggering conditions are resolved and independently verified.
4. A suspended member retains observer status and the right to address the Assembly, ensuring all actors remain at the table.

ARTICLE IX: ENTRY INTO FORCE, OFFICIAL LANGUAGES, DEPOSITARY, AND RELATIONSHIP TO EXISTING OBLIGATIONS

This Article completes the legal architecture of the Charter by addressing four foundational questions that every international treaty must answer.

Section 1 — Entry Into Force

This Charter enters into force when it has been signed by a minimum of five (5) Tier 1 Founding Steward nations as specified in Article II, provided that at least one signatory is from each of the following blocs: South Asia or the Indo-Pacific; Europe or the EU; and one additional democratic G7 state.

For states acceding after the Charter has entered into force, accession takes effect 90 days after the deposit of the instrument of accession with the Secretary-General, unless the Council Assembly by ordinary resolution sets a different date.

Section 2 — Official Languages

The official languages of the Global Stewardship Council are Arabic, Chinese (Mandarin), English, French, Hindi, Portuguese, Russian, and Spanish. All six UN official languages are included; Hindi and Portuguese are added to reflect the populations of the founding coalition.

In the event of any inconsistency between language versions, the English and French texts shall be equally authoritative for matters of legal interpretation, provided that where both are ambiguous, the Assembly shall commission a definitive interpretation by the Dispute Resolution Chamber.

Section 3 — Depositary

The Secretary-General of the Global Stewardship Council is the depositary of this Charter. The Secretary-General shall: receive all instruments of signature, ratification, accession, and withdrawal; certify that amendments have entered into force; communicate to all member states any notification, accession, or withdrawal received; and maintain the authentic text of the Charter in all official languages.

A certified copy of this Charter shall also be transmitted to the Secretary-General of the United Nations for registration under Article 102 of the UN Charter, affirming that the GSC operates transparently alongside and not in secret opposition to the existing international order.

Section 4 — Relationship to Existing Treaty Obligations

Membership in the Global Stewardship Council does not require Member States to violate their existing treaty obligations, including obligations under the United Nations Charter, existing security alliances, or bilateral trade agreements.

Where a GSC Council Assembly resolution conflicts with a UN Security Council resolution, the Member State shall notify both the GSC Secretary-General and the UN Secretary-General of the conflict. The GSC Assembly shall convene an emergency session within 72 hours to determine whether to (a) defer to the UN resolution, (b) seek mediation between the two bodies, or (c) by 2/3 emergency majority, maintain the GSC resolution as the operative standard for its members.

The purpose of this provision is not to subordinate the GSC to the UN Security Council veto that this Charter abolishes — but to ensure all conflicts between the two systems are handled transparently, with a defined process, rather than creating unpredictable legal chaos for Member States.

SUPPORTING EVIDENCE: KEY REFERENCES

Earth Stewardship and Trusteeship

- Maastricht Principles on Future Generations (OHCHR) — foundational legal text for the Seventh Generation Audit
- Kunming-Montreal Global Biodiversity Framework — 30×30 target aligns with GSC Biodiversity Index
- Earth Trusteeship Initiative — international law from ownership to guardianship

Planetary Boundaries and Climate Science

- Stockholm Resilience Centre — Planetary Boundaries (Sustainability Score basis)
- IPBES Global Biodiversity Assessment (Biodiversity Index data)

Nuclear Risk and Accountability

- Bulletin of the Atomic Scientists — Doomsday Clock (90 seconds to midnight)
- Arms Control Association — New START Expiry
- FAS — World Nuclear Forces 2026
- ICAN — Campaign to Abolish Nuclear Weapons (Nobel Peace Prize)

AI Governance

- EU AI Act — Official Text
- UN General Assembly Resolution 78/265 — first global AI governance resolution
- UN GA Resolution 79/239 — AI in the military domain (2025)
- Rome Statute of the ICC — Command Responsibility (Article 28)
- Vatican — Antiqua et Nova: Note on AI and Human Intelligence (January 2025)

Historical Context — Victor's Narrative

- National Security Archive — 1953 Iran Coup (Operation Ajax)
- UN — History of the Question of Palestine
- National Security Archive — NATO Expansion: What Gorbachev Heard (declassified)

Democracy and Human Rights

- Freedom House — Freedom in the World
- V-Dem Institute — Democracy Report

Trade and Economic Sovereignty

- WTO Dispute Settlement Understanding
- EU Anti-Coercion Instrument

JOINT SIGNING STATEMENT — JUNE 5, 2026

"In San José, we plant the seed of a new order —
not one based on the power to destroy, but on the duty to protect.
We invite all nations who believe that sovereignty is stewardship,
that data is culture, that future generations have rights,
and that the Earth is not ours to exhaust —
to sign this Charter and stand with us."

— Founding Stewards of the Global Stewardship Council
June 5, 2026 — World Environment Day — San José, Costa Rica

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This Charter belongs to no nation, no individual, and no political party.
It belongs to the Earth and to the generations who will inherit it.